



VALT · OWN THE MUSIC YOU LOVE

Final Report

Milestone 5: Closeout & Evaluation · final design, results and evaluation

Project: Afrocharts | Web3 Artist Portal (Awen), delivered as Valt | **Project Catalyst:** Fund 11, #1100019

Milestone cost: 15% (ADA 15,000) of ADA 100,000 | **Project completion:** 100% | **Prepared:** 30 September 2026

Live portal: <https://www.valt.digital> (Cardano pre-production testnet) | **Code:** <https://github.com/Awen-online/valt>

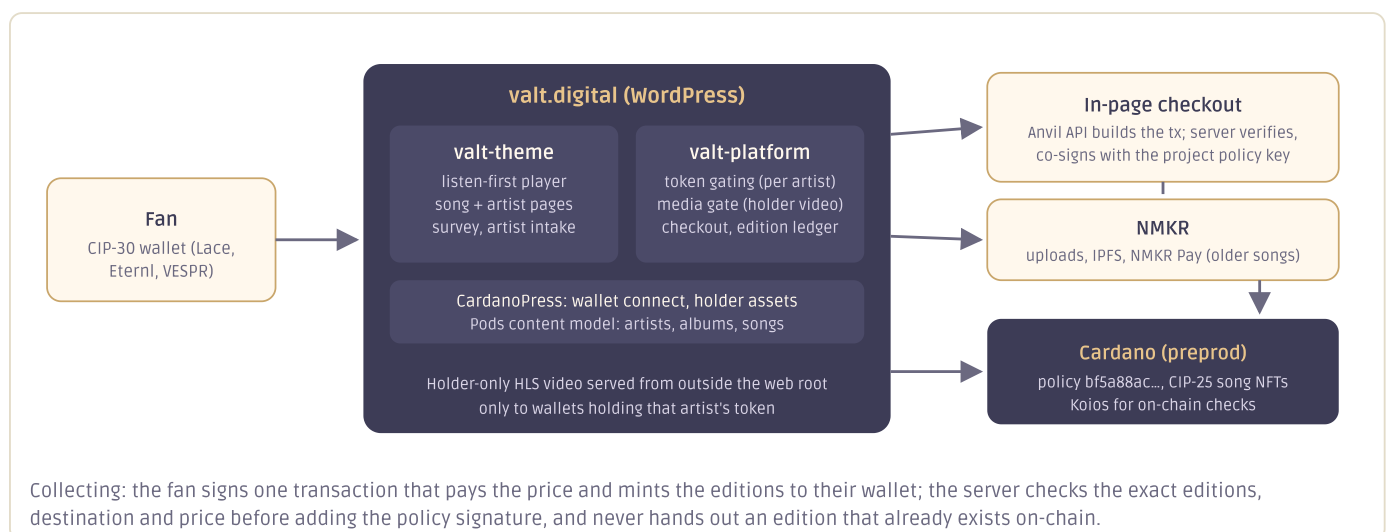
1. Summary

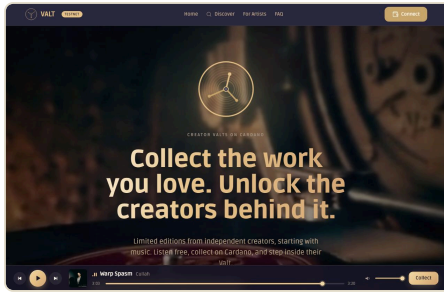
Valt is a live Web3 artist portal on Cardano: every song streams free and in full, fans collect limited editions with a Cardano wallet, and holding an edition unlocks that artist's private **Valt**, including holder-only music videos. Three artists and twelve songs are live. The platform launched publicly on 7 August 2026, was monitored and hardened through rollout (38 documented fixes), and its code is open source. Adoption is the weak point: the audience is small, feedback is a sample of five, and no third-party collector has bought an edition yet on testnet. This report states those results plainly next to what was built.

Registered Milestone 5 output	Status	Where
Getting user success stories, testimonials and other feedback	Delivered	\$4 Feedback and testimonials
Evaluate the impact of the Web3 integration on artists' recognition, opportunities and compensation	Delivered	\$5 Artist impact
Prepare a comprehensive report highlighting the metrics and analysis	Delivered	This report: \$2 final design, \$3 results, \$6 evaluation

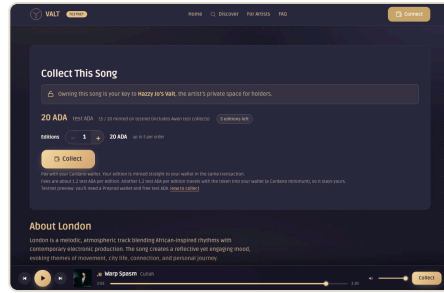
2. Final design

Valt is a WordPress application with two open-source components (the `valt-platform` plugin and the `valt-theme` theme). Fans connect a CIP-30 wallet; the server checks what the wallet holds before it reveals an artist's Valt or streams holder-only video; collecting builds a single Cardano transaction that pays and mints at once.

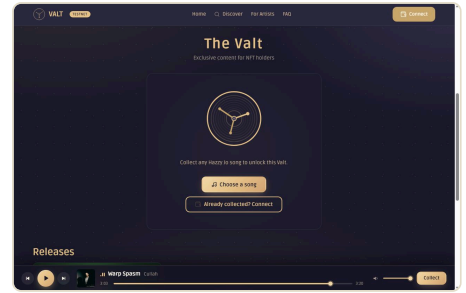




Homepage: listen free, collect on Cardano, step inside the artist's Valt.



Collect panel (London by Hazy Jo): 1 to 5 editions, test ADA, testnet mints labelled as including Awen test collections.



An artist's Valt as a non-holder sees it; holding any of the artist's songs unlocks it.

From NMKR Pay to an in-page Anvil checkout. Collecting first redirected to NMKR Pay's hosted checkout. When NMKR's testnet backend stalled (29 Sep) and multi-edition orders needed an undocumented price-list rule, we built an in-page checkout on the Ada Anvil transaction API: the fan's wallet signs one transaction that pays and mints 1 to 5 editions straight to the collector; the server verifies it before co-signing with the project's policy key; an edition ledger prevents double allocation, proven by a disclosed multi-wallet concurrency test; a live panel shows on-chain confirmation; and it works in mobile wallet browsers (VESPR). The result: faster and simpler, no redirect, payment and delivery atomic, and less dependence on one minting provider (NMKR still serves older songs).

Open source, owned by the community. Valt is a working concept on testnet that others can fork, run and extend. The public repository github.com/Awen-online/valt is MIT-licensed and holds about 16,000 lines of curated platform code (WordPress plugin, theme and mu-plugins), the valt-mint fallback minting tool, 19 PHPUnit tests with CI on PHP 8.1 to 8.3 plus a semgrep scan on every push, the milestone documents M1 to M5, and the rollout bug log that maps every fix to the public code. Reusable patterns for other Cardano builders: an in-page Anvil checkout with server-side transaction verification before the policy co-signature, per-artist token gating, a holder-only media gate, and a CIP-25/CIP-60 metadata builder. Together with the upstream CardanoPress fix (section 6), this is Awen's contribution to shared Cardano infrastructure. Contributions are welcome.

Design choices that came from feedback: music first (free full-track streaming and a persistent player), plain testnet labelling (test ADA, not dollars), a step-by-step **How to collect** guide, and collecting that works inside a phone wallet's in-app browser.

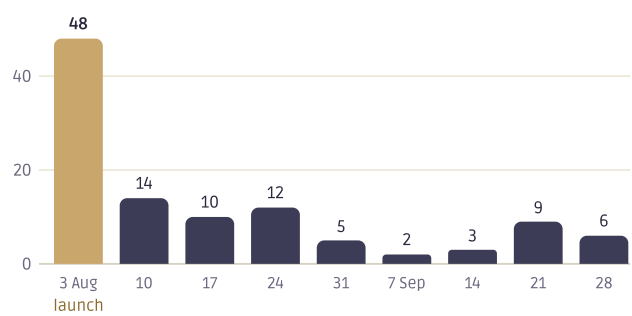
3. Results

Measured from launch (7 August) to 30 September 2026. Sources: first-party site analytics (bots excluded), the site database, the Cardano chain (Koios), and the Awen OS post scheduler. Figures are shown as measured, including zeros.

3 · 12 artists · songs live, each streaming in full	78 unique visitors since launch (133 page views, 83 sessions)	1,432 measured social reach and impressions for the launch posts, plus an email to 842 recipients	6 wallet-connected accounts on the site
+60 NPS from 5 responses (3 artists, 2 collectors)	1 unsolicited artist application (For Artists page)	38 rollout defects found and resolved, each documented	19 automated tests, CI green on PHP 8.1 to 8.3
46 song NFTs on-chain (48 minted, 2 burned)	17 editions collected through the new in-page checkout (Awen test purchases)	0 third-party purchases on testnet so far (tokens held by Awen wallets as tests)	3 holder-only videos live (London, Freakshow, Danse L'Intervention)

Weekly unique visitors

First-party analytics, bots excluded. Week of 3 Aug includes three pre-launch days.



From attention to ownership

Launch period, 7 Aug to 30 Sep 2026.

Social reach and impressions (measured posts)	1,432
Email recipients (29 Jul tester call; ~34% opened)	842
Unique site visitors	78
Visits to song or artist pages	11
Wallet-connected accounts (all time)	6
Third-party collectors	0

The drop between visitors and song pages is the main finding: most visitors read the homepage, For Artists and FAQ, and few went on to listen or collect.

Reach by post

Announcement	Reach / impressions	Engagement
Artist launch post, Instagram @cullahmusic (8 Aug)	875	45 likes, 3 shares, 1 comment, 1 save
Artist launch post, X @CullahMusic (8 Aug)	208	8 likes, 2 reposts, 4 clicks
Launch, LinkedIn Awen (7 Aug)	98	1 like, 1 share, 2 clicks
Launch, X @awen_online (7 Aug)	76	2 likes, 1 repost
One month on, LinkedIn / X / Instagram (21 Sep)	74 / 48 / 15	1 to 2 interactions each
Launch, Instagram awen.online (7 Aug)	38	7 likes, 3 comments
London release promo, X / Instagram / LinkedIn (30 Sep)	posted 30 Sep; not yet measured	

The artist's own channel reached more people than Awen's accounts combined, a result that shapes the next steps (\$6). Site analytics undercount visitors who block scripts and include some internal visits.

Awen ecosystem pipeline (sync.land)

82

artist profiles on sync.land covered by signed terms that authorise Valt releases

76

of those added since July, when the terms began naming Valt

2

artist pitches to the "Valt launch feature" brief (6 Sep)

677

published songs on sync.land (94 artist profiles, 152 users)

Accepting sync.land's terms is how any account continues on that platform; the terms authorise Valt releases, so these profiles are a pipeline of artists whose catalogue can be brought to Valt under signed terms, not artists who have used Valt. 41 legacy accounts remain on 2024 terms that do not name Valt. At least 2 referral clicks from sync.land to valtdigital were tracked (older clicks were not recorded); no sync.land newsletter mentioned Valt.

4. Feedback and testimonials (Output 1)

Feedback comes from the in-product survey (live since 4 August) and 1:1 conversations with artists and collectors, recorded in the same survey so every answer is comparable. Five responses are stored: three artists and two collectors, two of them after launch. This is the same dataset first reported in Milestone 3, now analysed for the closeout; no new responses were added and none are claimed.

Measure (n = 5)	Result
Net Promoter Score	+60: scores 10, 10, 9 (promoters), 8, 7 (passives), no detractors
What matters most	Artists: "the artist gets paid" (3 of 3). Collectors: exclusive access (1), owning it forever (1)
Appeal of fans sharing in a song's future earnings (1 to 5)	5, 5, 5, 5, 1
How they found Valt	Through an artist (2), the Cardano community (2), a friend (1)

In their words (anonymous survey answers, quoted as written):

"Follow an artist and get notified on new drops, plus a collector profile page I can share showing what I own." (collector)

"Pricing in local currency and a lower entry tier... 20 ADA is a real amount here. Also mobile wallet support; nobody I know uses a desktop extension." (collector)

"Can we crowdfund? and sell physical items too?" (artist)

Named artist testimonial: Mie (collected by email, 30 Sep 2026, quoted with permission)

"I'd describe Valt as a platform experimenting with a more direct relationship between artists and listeners, where music can be experienced normally but fans can also choose to collect and directly support the work they care about. The most interesting part to me is the potential to make digital music feel valuable and ownable again without asking fans to become crypto users first."

Mie, artist on Valt, 30 Sep 2026

"Seeing the songs actually streaming in full made it feel much more like a real music platform rather than a technology demonstration. I especially liked seeing Freakshow become something that could be collected, with the video functioning as something special for collectors."

"If someone needs a specific wallet, app, cryptocurrency, or prior knowledge of blockchain to collect a song, I think you lose a lot of ordinary music fans immediately. It should feel as familiar as buying something online: click, pay with a card or Apple Pay, and own it."

"If Valt could help artists reach people who genuinely might become fans, and then give those people an easy way to go from listener to supporter to collector or customer, that would solve a much bigger problem..."

This testimonial is separate from the n = 5 survey above; it confirms the same themes (access, price, simple payment).

Analysis. Satisfaction among the people who tried Valt is high, and artists are motivated by getting paid. Collectors value access and permanence more than returns, and their barriers are practical: price level, local currency and mobile wallets. **What we changed:** a listen-first site, test ADA shown plainly, a How to collect guide, follow buttons, and collecting inside phone wallet browsers (tested with VESPR on Android). Revenue-share ideas stay opt-in and artist-led. **Success stories:** the clearest one is the artist Cullah's launch post, which reached 875 people on Instagram, more than every Awen post together.

5. Artist impact: recognition, opportunities, compensation (Output 2)

Artist	Recognition	Opportunities	Compensation
Cullah	Artist page; six songs streaming in full; the launch was announced from the artist's own channels (875 Instagram reach, 208 X impressions).	A Valt holding <i>Danse L'Intervention</i> , a short film set to Cullah's music, streamed only to holders; a direct channel to collectors. On sync.land since 7 Aug: 24 plays by other listeners (3 completed), no licences yet.	Editions collected so far are Awen tests. No income yet (testnet).
Mie	Artist page; five songs (The Cave EP) streaming in full; Freakshow featured on the homepage. Mie: streaming "creates a very passive relationship", with "no obvious next step" to support the artist.	A Valt holding the official <i>Freakshow</i> music video (a Milwaukee Film Festival music video showcase selection), holders only. On sync.land since 7 Aug: 2 plays by other listeners, 3 add-to-cart.	No third-party collector yet. No income yet (testnet). In her words, streaming revenue is "so disconnected from the actual value of an engaged listener"; she would "rather have a smaller number of people meaningfully supporting my work".
Hazy Jo	Featured release (London) at the top of the homepage; release promotion on X, Instagram and LinkedIn (30 Sep).	A written licence (Awen doc 4762): 20 editions, the artist keeps all rights; the official London video in the artist's Valt, holders only.	A flat featuring fee under the licence (agreed; payment in progress). Edition income depends on mainnet.

Evaluation. The Web3 integration gives each artist things streaming alone does not: limited, verifiable editions whose size and price the artist sets; a private space for holders that the artist controls; and rights that stay with the artist. On **recognition**, the artists' own audiences did more than Valt's. On **opportunities**, the platform opened a new format (holder-only film and video), brought one unsolicited application from a new artist, and built a pipeline through sync.land: 82 artist profiles are covered by signed terms that authorise Valt releases (76 added since July), and a "Valt launch feature" brief drew 2 artist pitches. On **compensation**, the result is

honest and small: one flat featuring fee (agreed, payment in progress), and no edition income, because collecting runs on testnet and every token minted so far is an Awen test. Per-artist payouts are not built yet; sales settle to one project payout wallet.

Ecosystem contribution: a critical CardanoPress fix. CardanoPress is an open-source WordPress plugin used across Cardano sites for CIP-30 wallet login. While hardening Valt's token gating (Milestone 3), Awen found a critical wallet-authentication flaw: the wallet signature was checked, but the account identity came from separate client-supplied data, which allowed account takeover before login (the maintainer rated it "Critical"). We reproduced it against the plugin's own verification path, reported it privately to the maintainer, and shipped a mitigation on Valt meanwhile. It was fixed upstream in [CardanoPress v1.36.1](#) (17 July 2026), with the release notes crediting Cullah (valt.digital), and the maintainer [acknowledged it publicly](#). Why it matters: the fix protects every site that uses CardanoPress, not just Valt. Write-up: [awen.online](#).

6. Evaluation

What worked

- **The full loop works:** listen, collect, connect, unlock. A disclosed five-wallet test confirmed parallel checkouts never hand out the same edition, with confirmations in 50 to 102 seconds.
- **Holder-only video is enforced by the server** on every request, at adaptive quality.
- **Resilience:** when NMKR's testnet stalled on 29 Sep, the featured releases moved to an in-page checkout the next day; NMKR recovered and processed every held order.
- **Quality:** 38 rollout fixes, each traceable to the public code; 19 tests in CI.

Next phase: to be tested and rolled out

- **Market adoption:** mainnet rollout of the collect flow and first market sales to collectors.
- **Easier onboarding:** card checkout and walletless custody, so music fans need no crypto knowledge.
- **Wider feedback:** more listener and collector responses once collecting is on mainnet.
- **Artist income:** direct per-artist payouts from edition sales.

Lessons

- **Artists are the distribution.** An artist's own post outperformed the platform's; launches should be artist-led.
- **Hide the technology.** Mie and the survey agree: collecting should feel like buying online, "click, pay with a card or Apple Pay, and own it", and should turn listeners into supporters.
- **Lead with the music, not the token.** Access and listening come first; ownership is the reason to come back.
- **Remove the testnet step before asking fans to collect.** Real demand can only be measured on mainnet with familiar wallets.
- **Keep a second path for critical services** and verify each release end to end before announcing it.

7. Next steps

- **Mainnet**, starting with London by Hazy Jo (20 editions), after the readiness checklist: per-artist payouts, pricing that includes the checkout fee (0.15 ADA plus 1 ADA per edition, observed on testnet), and a uniform token metadata template (edition numbers, artwork, audio).
- **On-chain edition rules:** today edition caps are enforced by the checkout and the policy is a single-key script; an audited on-chain minting policy that enforces caps, price and the artist split is planned before scaling.
- **A card checkout and walletless custody**, so fans can collect without owning crypto, plus mobile wallet connection and a lower entry price tier.
- **Discovery to collector:** help new listeners find artists and move from listening to supporting to collecting.
- **Artist-led releases** through the For Artists pipeline, with the artist's channels as the main launch surface.

8. Limitations

- Valt runs on Cardano's pre-production testnet; collecting uses test ADA. Mainnet is a planned, separate step.
- No third-party purchase has been made; all 46 tokens are held by Awen-controlled wallets as tests, and none is presented as a sale.
- Security work is first-party (plus the upstream CardanoPress fix); no independent audit is claimed.

9. Links

- Closeout video: <https://awen.online/valt-closeout>
- Live portal: www.valt.digital · How to collect: valt.digital/how-to-collect
- Open-source code and all milestone documents: github.com/Awen-online/valt
- M4 Rollout Bug Log: [docs/M4_LaunchRollout/M4_Rollout_Bug_Log.pdf](#)